Teacher and cover planner

Employers and ways of working

Tuesday 24 November 2026 · P3 · 40 minutes · Year A

GROW · up to five learners · Independent is the default

Unit: Identity & Belonging — Belonging in work

Thread tags: SMSC S/So (M/C: none); British Values IL/MR (D/RL/T: none).

Exact source outcome

I can compare at least three ways of working and explain which features fit my preferences.

Weekly outcome: Students compare employer types and patterns of work, including SME, public sector, large employer and self-employment.

Source: specialist Careers scheme, GROW Careers physical row 12, Autumn 2 row 4. E12 weekly outcome; F12 focus; G12 exact outcome; H12 sequence; I12 timing; J12 evidence; K12 access; L12 support; M12 end check; N12 formative.

Question and success checks

Which features of a way of working would fit what matters to me?

1. Compare at least three case patterns using shared headings and card evidence. 2. Link a feature to a preference and explain why it fits. 3. Name a trade-off or question before treating that fit as a firm choice.

Prepare

Books, pens, four case cards, vocabulary mat and usual reading or typing aids. Keep the adult key apart from first choices. No web, login or pupil phone. Use the cards as prepared sources, with labels beside claims.

Source adaptation

All four cases are invented and unnamed. A small bakery represents a small business; the hospital ward is part of the public sector in this example; a warehouse planning role represents a large employer; a repair worker runs their own business. The cases illustrate combinations of type, work status and pattern. They do not define every workplace. Generic settings replace real organisations and places. No actual vacancy, pay, contract right or entry rule is asserted.

Where this leads

This helps me compare work with what matters to me and ask useful questions before choosing a next step.

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Forty minute teaching sequence

Phase	Min	Teaching and evidence
Retrieval	5	Recall how a source card can give a clue and still leave a gap. Neutral fallback: one example does not describe every job.
Explicit input	7	Separate employer type, employee/self-employed status and work pattern. Model a preference, case feature, reason and trade-off using A. Check that a label alone cannot prove fit.
Guided comparison	10	Read A–D. Compare fixed on-site work, on-site shifts, hybrid work and booked self-employed work. Discuss security, flexibility and support. Main hinge and parallel hinge; no one pattern is best for everyone.
Independent application	13	Choose at least three case patterns. Record comparable features and labels. Explain which feature fits a preference, why, and a trade-off or question. Give one next step and fade answer prompts.
Reflection	5	Ask the learner to justify a preferred pattern or type with evidence. Check all three comparisons. Retain first view, actual support and any change in the Careers Portfolio/action plan.

The five phases total 40 minutes. Reading, checks, feedback and access pauses sit within them. Slide 11 is an access reference; slide 12 is hidden for staff.

Worked example and fade

Practice model: “For this example, I value knowing my work days ahead. A has the same agreed weekdays, which could help me plan. Early starts may not fit me, so I would ask the exact times. B offers a rota, but the shifts change. C has agreed weekday hours, with a planned mix of office and remote work.” Point to A/B/C. A preference is a reason to investigate, not a final job decision.

Fade to a different feature: ask the learner to find support in B and C, then make their own comparison. They may include D. Retain normal reading or scribing access while answer prompts fade. Do not bank a copied model as personal preference evidence.

Check after explicit input

Ask privately: Does “small business” tell us the hours of every job there? Is hybrid work a mix of places or a promise to choose any hours? Expected: no; a mix of on-site and remote work. If unclear, point to the type and time/place fields and re-model the distinction.

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Routes and planned access

Independent

Compare at least three of A–D using shared headings: time/place, flexibility, support and security or a question. Name type/status and pattern accurately. Link a chosen feature to a current preference with a reason, then a trade-off or next question. Cases are evidence for examples, not rules about every employer.

Supported

Use one card and one heading at a time. Begin with A/B/C; D remains available. Highlight labels, model one separate reason and use the vocabulary bank. Rehearse privately. Keep at least three patterns and a reason for fit as the target. Fade answer prompts where secure.

Floor

Use A/B/C and the printed choices with the cards visible. Read aloud or scribe the learner's own choices. Compare three patterns, then ask which feature the learner values and why. Choosing three labels alone does not show comparison or personal fit. Record missing elements and any supplied answers as partial evidence.

Cognition and Learning

Use explicit instruction, a separate model and guided practice. Chunk by card and heading. Compare the same feature across cases. Repeat the feature–preference–reason routine, with extra processing time.

Communication and Interaction

Pre-teach employer, pattern, shift, hybrid, support and preference. Rehearse privately with short frames. Accept speech, pointing, reader, scribe or typing. Wait for thought; no cold calling or forced pair work.

SEMH

Keep a predictable sequence and private feedback. No household work, income or fixed future choice required. Offer a regulation break and planned return. A preference can be tentative and can change. A practice preference is available without pressure to disclose.

Sensory and Physical

Use clear print, a one-card view and normal aids. Do not infer what a learner can do from a case or their support needs. Discuss which support would help, without requiring health disclosure.

EAL

Plan in any language. Use examples to distinguish working place from working hours. Offer private oral rehearsal and a small word bank. Separate language access from comparative reasoning.

Record access separately from answer prompts. If a learner uses an invented preference, record hypothetical reasoning; the personal-fit part remains unconfirmed until the learner offers their own preference privately.

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Staff prompts and checks

Hinge during guided comparison

C is hybrid work for a warehouse planning role. Which claim fits? A: Every warehouse worker can work remotely and choose any hours. B: This planning role mixes agreed places and keeps agreed hours. Answer B. Ask for the time/place lines. If insecure, separate job task, place and hours, re-model C, then use the parallel hinge.

Parallel hinge

D is self-employed and books work with customers. Which claim fits? A: The worker can always choose any hours and has guaranteed work. B: The worker can suggest times, but bookings and customers affect the plan. Answer B. Ask for a card clue. If insecure, compare D's flexibility with its security line and retain a supported route.

Speaking frames

F: "Case ... works ... . The card says ... ." M: "A difference between ... and ... is ... . I value ... so ... could fit because ... ." H: "This feature may fit, but ... is a trade-off. I would check ... before choosing."

TA focus

I do: check type, status, pattern and card label. We do: ask for a case clue, not a preferred answer. Independent: record access and actual answer prompts, then fade prompts where secure. Help with a calm return and a purposeful next question.

Prompt ladder

1. Point to the place or instruction. 2. Ask a short question. 3. Rephrase the instruction. 4. Provide a scaffold or choice. 5. Model the first step only, then return the task.

Misconceptions and corrections

"A large or public employer guarantees a secure job." Type alone cannot establish the terms or length of a particular job. Check the contract and circumstances. "Flexible or self-employed means no limits on time." Customers, agreed hours, tasks and support arrangements can constrain choices. No pattern is best for everyone.

Evidence and source end check

J12: Employer/work-pattern comparison. M12: Can the student justify one preferred working pattern or employer type? Check the reason and case feature. Also check the full outcome: at least three ways compared and features linked to preferences. One justified choice alone is not the whole outcome.

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Assessment and safe teaching

What this lesson can evidence

Week 4 is formative. Keep a comparison of at least three patterns, source labels and relevant similarities/differences across common headings. Retain a preference, the linked feature and reason, plus a trade-off or question. Keep first thinking, actual support and any revision. The added trade-off/question supports cautious choice; assess the exact core outcome separately. A list of three names or a copied model is not enough.

Response and feedback

Book first. Type instead is an optional equivalent record. Reader, scribe, speech, pointing and typing are normal access. A learner may respond privately. If they choose a practice preference, log comparison and hypothetical reasoning without claiming their personal preference has been evidenced.

VF verbal feedback; WS worked with support; I independent; NS next step; // self-edit; ? read this back to me; E evidence recorded; R responded. Give one precise next step. R requires Voice and Audience, NS and the learner's response in the same colour, on the same page or usual mode. A private adult may be the audience. Use E only when actual evidence is banked.

Portfolio

Keep the comparison, preference type, reason, support and any revision in the Careers Portfolio/action plan. Offer to the Communication portfolio. Staff confirm any accredited mapping from actual work; no unit completion inferred. Use the open question as a next research step.

Teaching need next lesson _____ Next research question _____

Boundaries

Examples show possible arrangements only. Employer size/type, employee/self-employed status and work patterns can overlap in other combinations. The public-sector label applies only to this ward case; the hybrid pattern applies only to the warehouse planning role. Do not rank people or jobs by employer, pay or pattern. No household income, personal health or family employment disclosure. No legal or financial advice, actual employment terms or guaranteed outcomes. Follow the usual safeguarding route if needed.

Calendar and sequence

Year A. Autumn 2 Week 4, 23–27 November 2026. Tuesday 24 November, P3, 40 minutes. Week 6 retains mixed formative/summative source marking; Week 7 is assessing. Weeks 5–7 follow in order, one return after each Downloaded.

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